

- Q.6) (a) Explain the basic features of Post-Modernism in anthropology highlighting the work done by major scholars. (20 marks)

Post Modernism is a debate in anthropology that arose post world wars and was critical of existing theories and methods of anthropology.

Basic features

- ① It states that reality and truth is very subjective i.e. there is no absolute truth.
- ② It is against making grand theories as there is no objective reality.
- ③ It suggests that even science which was seen as objective was used to serve the interests of those in power.
- ④ Epistemological tendencies: It asks

reason for a reason to understand the social-political context which shaped the views of ethnographer while making theories.

④ Crisis of Representation critique: it is critical of existing ethnographies for ignoring marginalised sections.

⑤ Reflexivity: it calls for acknowledging one's own biases and re-evaluating research in light of these biases.

Key Scholars

→ Jacques Derrida → he calls for deconstruction i.e. no excessive loyalty to any theory or idea

and revisiting earlier ethnographies
to uncover their underlying bias.

→ Michael Foucault → he suggests that
knowledge is power and power
creates more knowledge to
support those in power.

